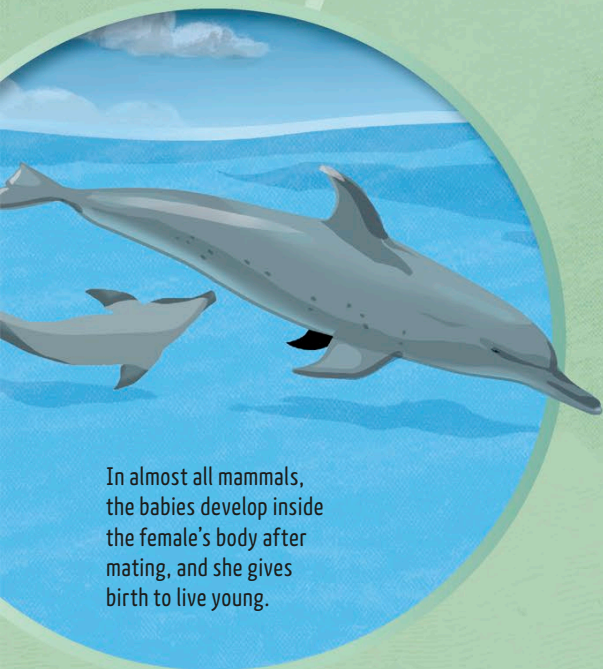


Sexual life cycles

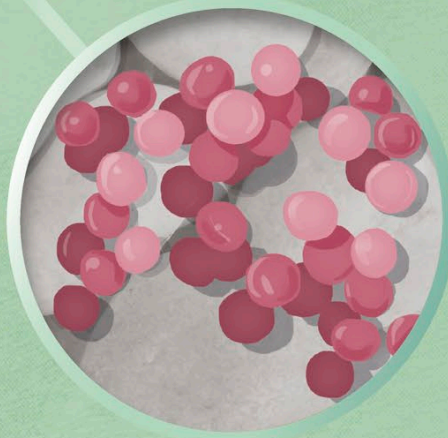
Sexual reproduction involves two parents—male and female—and each supplies a sex cell. The female egg cell fuses (joins) with the male sperm cell, in a process called fertilization. The fertilized egg develops into a new animal or plant.



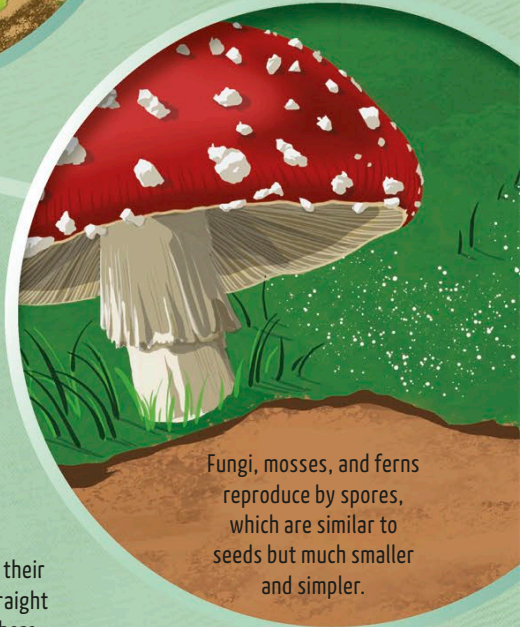
Seeds form when female egg cells in plants are fertilized by pollen (male sex cells). Each seed contains the beginning of a new plant.



In almost all mammals, the babies develop inside the female's body after mating, and she gives birth to live young.



Most fish release their eggs or sperm straight into the water—there, fertilization occurs.



Fungi, mosses, and ferns reproduce by spores, which are similar to seeds but much smaller and simpler.

Asexual life cycles

Some plants and animals reproduce asexually, from a single parent. The young develop from unfertilized eggs or form from a small part of the parent. The young are exact replicas (copies) of their parent.



New rocks form underground or when hot lava that erupts from volcanoes cools and hardens.



Dandelion flowers can make seeds asexually, without needing to be pollinated.